

Question Part

signals health and fertility, hence traits that aid mate selection and ultimately species survival. Simply put, by being beautiful, one has more, and better dating options, meaning a greater likelihood of finding a compatible long-term partner. Which research consistently links to better mental health, emotional stability and overall life satisfaction. But beauty extends far beyond just finding a partner, the "halo effect" is a cognitive bias where attractive people are automatically perceived as smarter, kinder, more competent and trustworthy than their less attractive peers. In fact, a phenomenon termed "beauty premium" provides irrefutable evidence to the argument that attractive individuals earn 10-15% more than their unattractive peers. Beauty, hence, opens doors for individuals born into disadvantage, beauty can also serve as a vehicle for social mobility via modelling, entertainment, and embedding themselves into the influence economy, allowing them to rise out of poverty in ways meritocracy could never achieve. Perhaps, this is why Plato terms physical beauty (love of a single beautiful body) as the first rung of the 'Ladder of Good'.

Clear argument about beauty as a blessing but where is the downfall.

Check your plan, you intended something else. Stick to your plan. It was a good one.

Question Part

Question Part

Q8

Topic
Answer 11

Est 11

Who?

Mulvey?

32 ✓

It was a
clear, complex
argument until
this last
part.
Confusing end.

Topic
Answer 11

Beauty is more of a curse than blessing because in today's world, it has ceased to be a human quality and has morphed into a commodity, something to be produced, priced, packaged and consumed. ✓
Karl Marx, founding father of Communism, warned that capitalism would eventually turn everything into a commodity, stripping everything of its intrinsic worth. What he did not predict, perhaps, is that this logic would extend to the human body itself. ✓
The rise of platforms such as OnlyFans is one of the main catalysts of this shift in society. Consider Bonnie Blue, the English 'content' creator who broke the Guinness world record for sleeping with the most number of men in 2025 (around 1000+), reportedly earning \$21 million per month. Bonnie's body is not incidental to her product, it is the product. Her beauty, youth and physical availability - like many adult content creators - are commodities being sold. ✓
The person and the offer put forth the model itself has become indistinguishable, which is precisely what Sartre feared when he wrote about 'The Gaze' that transforms a free, self-defining subject into an object defined entirely by others' perception. ✓
When one's beauty is their value, every dimension of their personhood becomes irrelevant, be it your intelligence, human kindness, depth of being. Bonnie is seen by millions but you can also argue that she is seen by none. ✓
She exists, publicly, only as a product to be consumed. ✓
And the tragedy here is that this commodification is rewarded, meaning that the marketplace incentivises the erasure of selfhood. The role completely one becomes a product, the role one is paid. ✓
reinforcing the vicious cycle that authenticity inherently is (economically irrational). ✓
The curse, hence, is not that beauty is valued, it is that in a commodified world (beauty is the only thing valued), and everything else about a person is reduced to zero. ✓
is it valued then? Confusing → do explain.
Yet, it would be intellectually dishonest to deny the measurable advantages that beauty confers. From an evolutionary standpoint, beauty is one of nature's most powerful blessings, allowing us to have more sexual options, climb the social ladder with more ease, and ultimately improve the quality of families. ✓
Darwin's theory of natural selection explains that 'beauty' in a human body, whether it's symmetry, clear skin, proportionality,

(planning last pg)



HWA CHONG INSTITUTION
C2 TIMED PRACTICE EXERCISE
Higher 1

GENERAL PAPER

Paper 1

8881/01

25 May 2023

1 hour 30 minutes

Answer **one** question.

Answers should be between 500 and 800 words in length.

1. How far would you agree that democracy is being used to oppress the minority?
2. 'Science is the antidote to ignorance.' To what extent is this true?
3. To what extent should sports be used for activism?
4. 'Sheltered and entitled.' Is this fair criticism of youth today?
5. 'Emboldened by social media.' Is this a cause for concern or celebration?
6. Is it true that there is no room for failure in your society?
7. 'Instead of solving problems, we are worsening them.' Comment.
8. Do you agree that beauty is more of a curse than a blessing?

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For Examiner's use only	
Question Number	
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Content	/30
Language	/20
Total	B. /50



HWA CHONG INSTITUTION
C2 BLOCK TEST
Higher 1

GENERAL PAPER

Paper 1

8881/01

19 June 2020 & 24 May 2022

1 hour 30 minutes

Answer **one** question.

Answers should be between 500 and 800 words in length.

1. 'What makes a country is a good piece of geography.' How important is geography in today's world?
2. 'An inclusive society that welcomes everyone.' How realistic is this goal for your society?
3. 'The internet has become a hotbed of lies and misguided notions.' Comment.
4. Is migration more of a boon or bane for developed countries?
5. 'So long as a government does its job well, whether it is democratic does not matter.' How far would you agree with this viewpoint?
6. 'The way to solve environmental problems is to drastically limit people's freedom.' Discuss.
7. "Attitude is a little thing that makes a big difference." (Winston Churchill) Consider the value of this observation for your society.
8. Are the arts anything more than a source of beauty in today's world?

can't → beauty as p-positiveness w/o purpose

You need
a
para
focus.

As such, art in today's world can be seen as a form of soft power, an economic engine, and a political weapon rolled into one. Kant's theory is a beautiful theory, ironically, but states do not fear beauty. They fear ideas and that is precisely what the arts provide?

You lack
a focus
& thus
an
argument

This is not to say, however, that art's deeper value is universally accessible.

Art's significance beyond beauty is dependent on material wealth, or more accurately, dependent on where art sits on Maslow's hierarchy of needs. Self-actualisation, the level at which art can function as existential courage, sits at the top of Maslow's pyramid. One cannot contemplate Dostoevsky's exploration of guilt while being stuck in a war-ridden country, worrying about survival. Hence, how one perceives the value of art is least through education and class privilege rather than innate. ??

In conclusion, the arts are not merely a source of beauty. They are how human beings confront chaos, challenge power and insist on meaning to endure suffering when the world offers none. Yet art's deeper value is unevenly distributed, and a privilege for only the comfortable. Whatever the arts are, a "source of beauty" does not even begin to cover it. ✓

12/30
13/2
X
You have a lot of ideas. Clearly you have read a lot of literary writers. The key to using that useful background is to identify a para focus, a topic sentence, in order to articulate a coherent argument. Once the argument is developed, then the arts can be used to support & further clarify the argument. Go back at the essay outlines & bullet points to review your style of writing.

This ties in with

moment of purposeless experience. Kant's argument that 'beauty' is defined as purposiveness without purpose. Even Oscar Wilde once mentioned that "all art is quite useless... and that's the point.", connoting that the moment you force art to have a separate function, you reduce it to propaganda or therapy. To make this more concrete, millions flood

the Louvre yearly to take a glimpse at the legendary Mona Lisa. Majority of these

people are probably not there to contemplate philosophy but simply to enjoy the sight and presence of it. There is nothing trivial about this. One can argue that beauty

might be the highest function in today's world, one of the last non-transactional

spaces in modern life.

However, if art were merely beautiful, no government would censor it. The

Nazi regime burnt modernist works in the 1930s. Russia jailed those involved in the Pussy

Riot. Governments do not imprison entities for making something pretty, they imprison

them for making something dangerous. Even in today's world, the pattern continues.

Authoritarian governments from Iran to Myanmar suppresses artistic expression because

it mobilises dissent in ways political opposition cannot. This means that art today

functions as a frontline tool of resistance. South Korea's "Hallyu wave" - BTS at the

UN, Parasite winning Best Picture, and Squid Game becoming a global phenomenon - has done

more for Korean geopolitical influence than decades of conventional diplomacy.

Under focus of the Para.

horrors acts of self-sacrifice and exclaim how beautiful they are; most people's instant reaction is "what the hell is happening", and ⁱⁿ this precise rupture in comfortable numbness lies the value of art. Art doesn't hide the unbearable aspects of existence, it configures them and gives horror a form we can endure. Crime and punishment by Dostoevsky drags the reader into the mind of a man who commits murder to test a philosophical theory, before crumbling under the weight of guilt he did not believe he would feel. Unbeknownst to most, Dostoevsky wrote multiple novels, including Crime and punishment, after living through chaos - a mock execution, years in a Siberian prison camp, crippling epilepsy etc - and transcribed that suffering into novels that essentially invented existential literature. In today's mental health epidemic, where the WHO identifies depression as leading cause of disability globally, ^{what does it refer to?} this function of art matters more than ever. Since depression is fundamentally a collapse of meaning (the feeling that nothing

This should be clearly articulated at the start

matters), art helps to take the raw chaos of suffering and give it form, structure and significance, offering a way to endure it. As Nietzsche puts it himself "we have art in order not to die of truth."

so that the para is developed to clearly show this idea

yet, one can argue that beauty is, and should be, art's primary function.

What is your para focus?

In today's hyper-monetised attention economy, where every click is ^{??} tracked and every interaction commodified (praise capitalism!), the beauty of art offers something rare - a

Ethan Lim.

There needs to be a gap for a motivation

Q8: What example on a link

In November 2013, a man walked into Moscow's Red Square, pulled down his trousers, and nailed his scrotum to the cobblestones. He sat there, emotionless, naked from the waist down in freezing temperatures, until police dragged him away. His name was Petr Pavlensky, and what he had just done was "art". A performance piece titled Fixation, he was protesting what he called the 'apathy' and 'political indifference' of the Russian society. It was not beautiful (not by any sane definition of the word at least). It was grotesque, painful and profoundly unsettling. But it was arguably the most powerful political statement made in Russia that year. If that is art, then clearly, art is doing something far more dangerous than being pretty. The arts — spanning literature, performance, music, theatre and beyond — are not merely sources of beauty. I would argue that the arts are acts of existential courage and powerful channels of confrontation, but one can only extract its true value when one's basic needs have been fulfilled, meaning its fullest value remains unevenly accessible across societies. For a them, the stud was be clear in response to the question. Firstly, the arts transcend beauty because, at their core, they represent

Unclear
Stud
&
Surv

Unclear
Function
of Arts

a voluntary descent into the chaos of life that today's comfort-addicted world so desperately needs. Jordan Peterson, the author of bestselling book 12 Rules of Life, argues that the human experience is divided between order (representing the known) and chaos (representing the unknown, the terrifying, the unexplored). Most people cling to order like cocaine addicts.

The artist, however, voluntarily steps into chaos, confronts what society is afraid to examine, and returns with something articulated — be it a painting, a novel or a

scrotum nailed to the ground. Pavlensky embodies this at its extreme, sewing his own mouth shut to protest the imprisonment of Pussy Riot, wrapping himself in barbed wire, and even setting fire to the door of the FSB headquarters. No one looks at these

The instruction to the class was NOT to leave like.